

# Lee-Ann Vidal-Covas | PhD

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## Educación

- 2025 **Ph.D., Boston University, Lingüística**  
Disertación doctoral: *Covariation & salience in linguistic contact: a sociophonetic study of liquid variation in Boston Spanish*  
Comité: Daniel G. Erker (Chair), Neil J. Myler & Kate Lynn Lindsey
- 2021 **M.A., Boston University, Lingüística**
- 2013 **M.A., Louisiana State University, Estudios Hispánicos y Lingüística**  
Tesis: *El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico*  
Comité: Rafael Orozco, Jeremy King & Andrea Morris
- 2011 **B.A., Louisiana State University, Estudios Hispánicos y Literatura**
- 2020 **The New York – St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition, and Culture, Cursos en sistemas de escritura y fonología, morfología, lingüística experimental y sintaxis**

## Publicaciones

### Artículos en revistas arbitradas

- 2024 Erker, Daniel G. & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Variation, Contact, and Change in Boston Spanish: How social meaning shapes stylistic practice and bilingual optimization. *Studies in Hispanic and Lusophone Linguistics*, 17(2), 223–249. [DOI]

### Actas arbitradas

- 2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** ¿Va primero el verbo? or ¿El sujeto va primero?: Subject-verb order in Latin American Spanish. *Proceedings of the Linguistic Society of America*, 8(1), Article 5542, pp. 1–17. [DOI]
- 2014 Orozco, Rafael; Méndez Vallejo, Catalina; & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Los efectos condicionantes del verbo en el uso variable de los pronombres personales de sujeto. *Actas del XVII Congreso Internacional de la Asociación de Lingüística y Filología de la América Latina*, pp. 1–17.

### Contribuciones a volúmenes editados (por invitación)

- 2022 Erker, Daniel G. & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** What we say when we say nothing at all: Clues to contact-induced language change in Spanish conversational pause-fillers. *Estudios del Observatorio / Observatorio Studies*, 80, pp. 1–29.
- Erker, Daniel G. & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Qué decimos cuando no decimos nada: Claves del cambio lingüístico inducido por contacto en las pausas llenas del español conversacional. *Estudios del Observatorio / Observatorio Studies*, 80, pp. 1–31.

### Volúmenes editados

- 2021 Dionne, Danielle & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** (Eds). *Proceedings of the 45<sup>th</sup> Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*. Somerville, MA, Cascadilla Press.

### Otras publicaciones

- 2013 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico. *LSU Master's Theses*, 3876. [DOI]

## Presentaciones

### Ponencias arbitradas

- 2024 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** How Salience Influences Dialectal Persistence and Covariation: Insights from Boston's Spanish-Speaking Community, *New Ways of Analyzing Variation* 52, Miami, FL, Nov 7<sup>th</sup> – 9<sup>th</sup>.
- Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Investigating Salience and Ideologies in Greater Boston: a Sociophonetic Analysis of Liquid Variation, *International Symposium on Language Ideologies and Attitudes*, Palma de Mallorca, Spain, October 17<sup>th</sup> – 19<sup>th</sup>.
- Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Riding the Waves of Salience: Exploring Spanish Liquid Variation among Boston Spanish speakers, *LSA 2024*, NYC, New York, January 4<sup>th</sup> – 7<sup>th</sup>.

- 2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Making a Splash: The Saliency of Liquid Variation among Boston Spanish speakers, *New Ways of Analyzing Variation* 51, NYC, New York, October 13<sup>th</sup> – 15<sup>th</sup>.
- 2014 Orozco, Rafael; Méndez Vallejo, Catalina; & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** The Verb as a Predictor of Variable Pronominal Use in Spanish, *New Ways of Analyzing Variation* 43, Chicago, Illinois, October 23<sup>rd</sup> – 26<sup>th</sup>.  
 Orozco, Rafael; Méndez Vallejo, Catalina; & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Los efectos condicionantes del verbo en el uso variable de los pronombres personales de sujeto, *The Association of Linguistics and Philology Latin America Conference*, Paraíba, João Pessoa, Brazil, July 14<sup>th</sup> – 19<sup>th</sup>.  
 Orozco, R., Méndez Vallejo, Catalina, & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Verb-related Constraints on Variable Pronominal Use: Do we have all the Answers?, *7<sup>th</sup> International Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics*, Madison, Wisconsin, April 3<sup>rd</sup> – 5<sup>th</sup>.  
 Orozco, Rafael; Méndez Vallejo, Catalina; & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** The Effects of Verb Semantics on Pronominal Expression: A Preliminary Study, *XXIX Biennial Louisiana Conference on Hispanic Languages & Literatures*, Baton Rouge, Louisiana, Feb 27<sup>th</sup> – March 1<sup>st</sup>.  
**Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico, *XXIX Biennial Louisiana Conference on Hispanic Languages & Literatures*, Baton Rouge, LA, Feb 27<sup>th</sup> – March 1<sup>st</sup>.
- 2013 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Variable use of subject pronouns in the Spanish in Louisiana, *2nd Graduate Symposium Universidad de Puerto Rico*, Río Piedras, Puerto Rico, April.  
**Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M. & Linder, Cali.** Variable use of subject pronouns in Spanish, *Southeastern Conference on Linguistics LXXX*, Spartanburg, South Carolina, April 4<sup>th</sup> – 6<sup>th</sup>.

### Charlas por invitación

- 2024 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Salient Features, Strong Identities: Social Meaning and Stylistic Choices in Boston Spanish, *World Languages, Literatures & Cultures Department – Louisiana State University*, New Orleans, LA, Dec 3<sup>rd</sup>.
- 2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Making a Splash: The Saliency of Liquid Variation among Boston Spanish speakers, *Linguistics Program – Northeastern University*, Boston, MA, March 23<sup>rd</sup>.
- 2020 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Guest Lecture: English/Spanish Contrastive Phonology & Filled Pauses, *Intro to Sounds – Boston University*, Boston, MA, October 15<sup>th</sup>.
- 2017 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Teaching Foreign Language in the 21<sup>st</sup> Century Classroom, *Louisiana Education Technology Consortium*, Baton Rouge, LA, March.

### Pósters arbitrados

- 2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** ¿Va primero el verbo OR El sujeto va primero?: Subject-Verb order in Latin American Spanish, *LSA 2023*, Denver, CO, January 5<sup>th</sup> – 8<sup>th</sup>.
- 2021 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Filled pauses as a site of language contact among Spanish-speaking Bostonians, *LSA 2021*, Virtual, January 9<sup>th</sup>.

### Conferencias departamentales y de campus

- 2025 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Covariation & saliency in linguistic contact: a sociophonetic study of liquid variation in Boston Spanish, *Dissertation Defense – Boston University*, Boston, MA, April 7<sup>th</sup>.
- 2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Making a Splash: The Saliency of Liquid Variation among Boston Spanish speakers, *Graduate Research Forum – Boston University*, Boston, MA, March 20<sup>th</sup>.
- 2020 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Filled pauses as a site of language contact among Spanish-speaking Bostonians, *Graduate Research Forum – Boston University*, Virtual, December 2<sup>nd</sup>.
- 2013 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico, *LSU Spanish Roundtable*, Baton Rouge, LA, October.

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### Distinciones y Premios

- 2019 **Student-Nominated Teaching Appreciation Award**, *St. Joseph's Academy*, Baton Rouge, Reconocimiento estudiantil por impacto académico y personal positivo
- 2013 **Graduate Presentation Award**, *2nd Graduate Symposium*, Universidad de Puerto Rico–Río Piedras, Otorgado por presentación destacada en congreso (USD 200)

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### Becas y Financiamiento

## Becas y subvenciones de investigación

- 2018 – 2024 **Graduate Student Fellowship**, *Boston University GRS & Office of the Provost*, Fall 2023, Spring 2024  
**Graduate Student Fellowship**, *Boston University Linguistics Department*, Spring 2019, Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Spring 2023  
**Research Fellowship**, *Boston University Linguistics Dept*, Sum 2019, Fall 2019, Sum 2020, Fall 2020, Spring 2021, Fall 2021  
**Teaching Fellowship**, *Boston University Linguistics Department*, Fall 2018, Spring 2020  
**Graduate Research Grant**, *Boston University Linguistics Department*, Spring 2021, USD 1,000
- 2016 – 2017 **21<sup>st</sup> Century Classroom Research Grant**, *Saint Joseph's Academy*, USD 10,000
- 2012 – 2013 **Teaching Fellowship**, *Louisiana State University Foreign Languages & Literatures Department*, Spring 2012, Sum 2012, Fall 2012, Spring 2013, Sum 2013, Fall 2013

## Becas de viaje y registro a congresos

- 2023 – 2024 **Becas para viajes a conferencias**, *Boston University Linguistics Department & Graduate Student Organization*, financiaron difusión de investigaciones en congresos nacionales e internacionales, Total recibido: USD ≈4,200
- 2024 **Student Registration Award**, *IDEOLING Organizing Committee*, Fundació Universitat Empresa de les Illes Balears, EUR 100
- 2021 **LSA Registration Award**, *Committee on Ethnic Diversity in Linguistics*, Linguistic Society of America
- 2013 **Becas para viajes a conferencias**, *Louisiana State University*, financiaron difusión de investigaciones en congresos nacionales e internacionales, Total recibido: USD ≈1,500

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## Experiencia Investigadora

### Investigadora Graduada

- 2021 – 2025 **Disertación doctoral**  
Covariation & Salience in Linguistic Contact: A Sociophonetic Study of Liquid Variation in Spanish in Boston  
Comité: Daniel G. Erker (Chair), Neil J. Myler & Kate Lynn Lindsey
- 2020 – 2021 **2<sup>nd</sup> Ph.D. Qualifying Paper**  
Subject-Verb Order in Latin American Spanish  
Comité: Neil J. Myler (1<sup>st</sup> Reader), Daniel G. Erker, & Paul Hagstrom
- 2019 – 2020 **1<sup>st</sup> Ph.D. Qualifying Paper**  
Filled Pauses as a site of dialectal and language contact among Spanish-speaking Bostonians  
Comité: Daniel G. Erker (1<sup>st</sup> Reader), Neil J. Myler, & Jon Barnes
- 2011 – 2013 **Tesis de Máster**  
El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico  
Comité: Rafael Orozco (Chair), Jeremy King, & Andrea Morris

### Asistencias de Investigación

- 2018 – 2025 **Sociolinguistics Lab**, *Spanish in Boston Project*, Director: Daniel G. Erker
- 2020 – 2021 **Structures of Under-researched Languages Lab**, *The Mirror Principle Violations Project*, Director: Neil Myler

### Trabajo de Campo Lingüístico

- 2012 – 2013 **Español puertorriqueño**, en Puerto Rico y Luisiana

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## Experiencia Docente

### Boston University

- 2018 – 2021 **Language and Music**, (*CAS LX 120*), Fall 2021  
Correctora para Daniel G. Erker
- Introduction to Sound Systems**, (*CAS LX 301/601*), Fall 2020  
Asistente de curso para Kate Lynn Lindsey
- Say what? Accents, Dialects, and Society**, (*CAS LX 110*), Fall 2018, Spring 2020  
Asistente de curso para Neil J. Myler

### Academy of the Sacred Heart (Middle School)

- 2017 – 2018 **Introductory Spanish & Basic Technology**  
Instructora

### Saint Joseph's Academy (High School)

2014 – 2017 **Elementary Spanish I & II; Computer & Software Orientation**  
Instructora

Louisiana State University

2012 – 2013 **Elementary Spanish I & II, Span 1101 & 1102**  
Instructora

**Servicio**

Al departamento

2021 – 2022 **Organizadora Estudiantil de Posgrado**, *Linguistics Department Colloquium Series*, Boston University

2021 **Panelista**, *Virtual Open House for MA/PhD Linguistics Programs*, Boston University, December 13<sup>th</sup>

2020 **Panelista**, *Panel on PhD Applications*, Boston University, November 4<sup>th</sup>

2019 **Gestora del laboratorio**, *Sociolinguistics Lab*, Boston University

A la disciplina: revisión editorial

2026 – **3 revisiones de manuscrito** para: *Studies in Hispanic and Lusophone Linguistics, Asia-Pacific Language Variation*

A la disciplina: comités

2020 **Co-organizadora**, *45<sup>th</sup> Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*

**Presidenta de Patrocinios**, *45<sup>th</sup> Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*

2019 **Presidenta de Voluntarios**, *44<sup>th</sup> Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*

A la disciplina: otros

2021 **Voluntaria**, *95<sup>th</sup> Annual Meeting Linguistic Society of America (LSA2021)*

2018 **Voluntaria**, *43<sup>rd</sup> Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*, Boston University

2014 **Voluntaria**, *XXIX Biennial Louisiana Conference on Hispanic Languages & Literatures*, LSU

2013 **Voluntaria**, *LXXX SouthEastern Conference on Linguistics (SECOL)*, Spartanburg, SC

2012 **Voluntaria**, *XXVIII Biennial Louisiana Conference on Hispanic Languages & Literatures*, LSU

Otro servicio

2014 – 2017 **Co-organizadora**, *Louisiana Association of High School Spanish Clubs' Annual Conference*

**Idiomas**

|           |                                                         |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Nativa    | Inglés, Español                                         |
| Básico    | Portugués brasileño                                     |
| Fieldwork | Indonesio, Groenlandés Occidental, Wichita, Yagua, Zulú |

**Tecnología**

|        |      |                   |      |
|--------|------|-------------------|------|
| R      | ●●●● | Bash              | ●●●● |
| VSCode | ●●●● | ΛT <sub>E</sub> X | ●●●● |
| GitHub | ●●●● | HTML              | ●●●● |
| Python | ●●●● | regex             | ●●●● |

**Ciudadanía**

Doble Ciudadanía Estadounidense & Española